Child interview and suitability record: Years 1 and 2

Child's name	
Year group applied for	
Date	
Interviewer	
Others present (for example receiving homeroom teacher; Chinese-speaking colleague)	

About 6 minutes, 1:1, play-based. Most of what you need about a 5 or 6 year old comes from watching them during the whole visit, not from questions. This short chat, at the end of the visit, is **in English**. It has three jobs: to hear the child's spoken English, to get to know the child (likes, family, friends, **what they want to be**), and to judge their readiness for the international programme. Use the observation boxes in Section 4 for the whole visit.

How to do it. Sit on the floor or at a low table beside the child. Offer paper and crayons: "Can you draw you, doing something you love?" Talk about the drawing. Ask the main question first; if the child does not answer, use the **easier** prompt (a choice, a yes or no, or "show me"). Wait. Praise effort. Never press a child who is upset; stop and let them go back to their parent.

Safeguarding. A young child is never alone with one adult behind a closed door. If a child says something that worries you, write down their words and pass it to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day.

1. Questions

Topic	Main question	Easier	Notes
Me	What is your name? How old are you?	Show me with your fingers.	
	Tell me about your picture.	Is this you? What are you doing?	
Family	Who lives at your home?	Do you have a brother? A sister? A pet?	
Likes	What do you like to play?	Do you like to run? Draw? Play with blocks?	
	What is your favourite food? Favourite animal?	Do you like noodles? Do you like cats?	
School	Tell me about your school (or kindergarten).	Do you like it? What do you do there?	
	Who are your friends?	Do you play with friends?	
Feelings	What makes you happy?	Are you happy today? (point to a happy or sad face)	
When I grow up	What do you want to be when you grow up?	A teacher? A doctor? A footballer?	
Here	Would you like to come to this school? What would you like to do here?	Do you want to play here? Learn English here?	

2. Speaking band

Circle the band that fits best, for a child of this age.

Band	What you hear
A New to English	No English yet, or one or two words. Uses Chinese, pointing or silence. May copy a word you say.
B Early acquisition	Single words and short phrases ("cat", "my mummy", "I like red"). Understands simple questions with gesture or pictures.
C Developing competence	Short sentences about familiar things ("I play with my friend"), with errors. Understands most simple questions.
D Competent	Talks in sentences, tells you about the picture or a simple event, joins ideas with "and" or "because".
E Fluent	Talks as a fluent English-speaking child of 5 or 6 would.

Speaking band: **A** **B** **C** **D** **E** Listening in conversation: **A** **B** **C** **D** **E**

3. Observations during the whole visit

Tick what you saw, and add a note.

What to look for	Seen	Notes
Separates from the parent without great distress, or settles within a few minutes	☐	
Joins in the activities and stays with each one for a few minutes	☐	
Follows a simple instruction (with gesture if needed)	☐	
Holds a pencil or crayon with control; draws a person with several parts	☐	
Takes turns, shares, waits	☐	
Shows curiosity: looks, touches, asks, explores	☐	
Copies new English words, or tries to	☐	
Recovers when something is hard or when they do not understand	☐	
Uses the toilet, coat and shoes independently (ask the parent)	☐	

4. Readiness

Rate each strand. **1** Concern, **2** Some concern, **3** Good, **4** Strong. Write the evidence.

Strand	What strong looks like at this age	Rating	Evidence
Attitude to learning	Enjoys the activities, has a go, pleased with success	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Curiosity and engagement	Interested, explores, asks questions	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Social and emotional readiness	Settles with new adults, manages separation, plays alongside or with others	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Independence	Manages simple tasks and self-care for age	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Kindness and conduct	Gentle, polite, shares	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Readiness for learning in English	Happy in an English-speaking setting, tries words, is not distressed by not understanding	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	

5. Anything to follow up

Area	Tick	Notes
Speech and language (for example very little speech in Chinese as well as English, unclear speech for age)	☐	
Attention, hearing, vision, movement or fine motor skills	☐	
Wellbeing (for example very anxious, very tired)	☐	
Safeguarding (passed to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day)	☐	
Medical or dietary	☐	

Speech in Chinese. Ask the parent how the child speaks in Chinese (Parent Conversation Record, Section 4). A child with little English but age-appropriate Chinese is a typical English learner. A child who also has very little speech in Chinese for their age may need a speech and language check: raise it with the parent gently, as a question rather than a conclusion.

6. Receiving homeroom teacher (optional)

First impressions and what the child would need in the first weeks (for example a buddy, picture cards for routines, a familiar comfort object, a gradual start).

Interviewer signature and date